NORTHERN RESILIENCE INITIATIVES (NRI)

Safeguarding Policy

Protecting children, adults at risk, staff, volunteers and community members

Purpose

Northern Resilience Initiatives (NRI) is committed to carrying out its community development work in a way that respects people's dignity, safety and rights. This policy sets out the basic standards NRI will use to prevent and respond to abuse, exploitation, harassment, neglect and other forms of harm connected to its activities.

Organization contact

NORTHERN RESILIENCE INITIATIVES (NRI)
Northern Kenya
Email: resiliencenorthern@gmail.com
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1. Scope

This policy applies to NRI's governing leaders, staff, volunteers, consultants, contractors, partners and anyone representing NRI. It applies during meetings, field visits, water and climate-resilience activities, school-related activities, community outreach, transport, online communication and any other activity linked to NRI.

2. Safeguarding principles

Treat every person with dignity and respect. Do not discriminate or exploit a position of trust. Put the safety and best interests of children first. Take concerns seriously, respond promptly and share information only with people who need it to protect someone or address a concern. Never promise absolute secrecy when someone may be at risk.

3. Prohibited conduct

Abuse, exploitation, neglect, bullying, sexual harassment, sexual exploitation, grooming, intimidation, physical punishment, degrading treatment and retaliation against anyone who raises a concern are prohibited.

Staff and representatives must never exchange money, employment, goods, services or project benefits for sexual contact or favours. Sexual activity with a child (a person under 18) is prohibited regardless of local age of consent. Adults must maintain appropriate professional boundaries and must not use NRI work to seek personal, financial or sexual advantage.

4. Safe working practices

Use respectful language and behaviour. Avoid being alone with a child in an isolated place where safer arrangements are possible. Obtain appropriate parent or guardian permission and the child's assent before photographs, interviews or public stories involving children. Explain how images or information will be used, protect identifying details where necessary, and do not publish material that exposes a person to danger or humiliation.

For community visits and project activities, assess foreseeable risks, use safe venues and transport, and ensure children and adults at risk know how to raise concerns. Do not promise assistance or benefits in exchange for participation, images or personal information.

5. Recruitment and training

NRI should use proportionate reference and suitability checks for roles involving contact with children or adults at risk, consistent with applicable Kenyan law. Representatives should receive an induction on this policy and know how to report concerns. Any required background checks must be completed before relevant duties begin.

6. Reporting a concern

Anyone who witnesses, experiences or suspects harm connected to NRI should report it as soon as safely possible to the designated safeguarding contact or an appropriate NRI leader. Reports may be made verbally or in writing. If a child or another person is in immediate danger, contact the relevant emergency services or child-protection authorities first where safe to do so.

Listen calmly, take the person seriously, record their words as accurately as possible, note dates and facts, and avoid leading questions. Do not investigate, confront the alleged person responsible, or circulate allegations. Refer the concern promptly to an appropriate authority where required.

7. Response, confidentiality and non-retaliation

NRI will assess immediate safety needs, take reasonable protective steps, document decisions securely and refer matters to qualified authorities when appropriate or legally required. Information will be shared on a need-to-know basis, subject to safeguarding and legal obligations. Retaliation against a reporter or person participating in a good-faith report is prohibited.

8. Responsibilities and review

NRI leadership is responsible for appointing a safeguarding focal person, ensuring representatives understand this policy, and reviewing incidents and implementation. The focal person's name and contact details must be added before adoption. Review this policy at least annually and after a serious incident, a major programme change or a relevant legal change.

9. Approval and document control

Status: Approval body, approver name, approval date and next review date must be completed by NRI before the policy is treated as formally adopted.

NORTHERN RESILIENCE INITIATIVES (NRI)

Code of Conduct

Standards of behaviour for NRI leaders, staff, volunteers and representatives

Purpose

This Code of Conduct describes the behaviour expected of everyone acting for Northern Resilience Initiatives. It supports NRI's stated values of community empowerment, resilience, integrity, inclusion, sustainability, innovation and collaboration.

Organization contact

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Northern Kenya
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1. Who must follow this code

This code applies to governing leaders, staff, volunteers, consultants, contractors and other representatives while carrying out NRI work or representing NRI publicly.

2. Respectful and inclusive conduct

Treat community members, colleagues, partners and service users with dignity and fairness. Do not discriminate, harass, bully, threaten or humiliate anyone. Make reasonable efforts to include women, youth, children, people with disabilities and other groups who may face barriers to participation.

3. Integrity and responsible use of resources

Be honest in records, communications, reports and claims about NRI's work. Do not falsify information, misuse funds or equipment, accept bribes, demand unofficial payments, or use organizational resources for unauthorized personal gain. Declare actual or potential conflicts of interest and follow the decision made by NRI leadership.

4. Safeguarding and professional boundaries

Follow NRI's Safeguarding Policy and relevant laws. Do not exploit power differences, seek sexual favours in exchange for assistance, or retaliate against someone who raises a concern. Protect confidential and personal information.

5. Community engagement and communications

Explain project activities honestly and do not promise support that has not been approved or funded. Obtain informed permission before collecting or publishing personal stories, photographs or identifiable information. Respect community knowledge, culture and privacy, and correct inaccurate public statements about NRI when identified.

6. Health, safety and the environment

Follow reasonable safety instructions during fieldwork, report hazards and incidents, and avoid activities that put community members or colleagues at unnecessary risk. Respect the environment and local resources in NRI activities.

7. Reporting breaches and consequences

Report suspected misconduct to an appropriate NRI leader or designated contact. Reports will be handled fairly and as confidentially as practicable. Depending on the circumstances and applicable procedures, breaches may lead to guidance, retraining, removal from duties, termination of engagement or referral to authorities. Serious allegations should be handled fairly, with an opportunity for relevant parties to respond, without compromising safety.

8. Approval and review

Status: NRI leadership should confirm reporting channels, disciplinary procedures and approval details before adoption. Review at least annually.

NORTHERN RESILIENCE INITIATIVES (NRI)

Financial Management Policy

Responsible stewardship, transparency and accountability

Purpose

This policy provides a practical starting framework for managing money and assets received or used by Northern Resilience Initiatives. It is intended to support sound records and accountability as NRI develops its programmes and funding relationships.

Organization contact

NORTHERN RESILIENCE INITIATIVES (NRI)
Northern Kenya
Email: resiliencenorthern@gmail.com
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1. Scope and principles

This policy applies to all funds, grants, donations, project income, bank or mobile-money transactions, purchases and assets managed on behalf of NRI. Funds must be used only for authorized organizational purposes, consistent with donor conditions and applicable law.

2. Roles and separation of duties

NRI's governing body should approve financial procedures, budgets and delegated spending limits. Where practicable, the person requesting a purchase, approving it, paying for it and reconciling the transaction should not be the same person. If the organization is small and full separation is not possible, an independent leader should review the records regularly.

3. Budgets and approvals

Each funded activity should have an approved budget before commitments are made. NRI should document who can authorize expenditure and set written approval limits appropriate to its size. Spending outside an approved budget requires documented authorization. No person should approve their own reimbursement.

4. Receiving and banking funds

Record donations, grants and other income promptly, including the date, source, amount, purpose and any restrictions. Issue acknowledgements where appropriate. Use accounts authorized by NRI's governing body and keep organizational money separate from personal money. Avoid cash where practical; where cash is necessary, use receipts, secure storage and prompt deposits.

5. Purchasing and payments

Purchases should be necessary, reasonable in price and related to an approved activity. Keep quotations or a written explanation when competitive quotations are not practical. Retain invoices, receipts, payment confirmations and evidence that goods or services were received. Disclose supplier relationships or other conflicts of interest before a decision is made.

6. Records, reconciliation and reporting

Maintain accurate records of income, expenditure, bank and mobile-money statements, receipts, contracts, budgets, assets and donor restrictions. Reconcile accounts regularly, preferably monthly, and have someone other than the person handling day-to-day transactions review the reconciliation where practicable. Provide periodic financial reports to NRI leadership and donors as required.

7. Assets, fraud and suspected misuse

Maintain an asset register for significant equipment and property, including purchase date, cost, location and responsible custodian. Report suspected fraud, theft, bribery or misuse promptly to an appropriate leader. Preserve relevant records and avoid conducting informal investigations that could compromise evidence. Refer matters to competent authorities when appropriate or required.

8. Donor funds, records retention and review

Use restricted funds only for the agreed purpose and comply with grant conditions. Retain financial records for the period required by applicable law, donor agreements and NRI's approved records schedule. Obtain professional accounting or legal advice where needed.

9. Approval and review

Status: NRI must add its actual bank signatories, approval limits, reporting schedule, accounting arrangements and approval details before adoption. Review annually.

NORTHERN RESILIENCE INITIATIVES (NRI)

Complaints and Whistleblowing Policy

Safe, fair and accessible ways to raise concerns

Purpose

Northern Resilience Initiatives wants community members, staff, volunteers, partners and other stakeholders to be able to raise concerns about its work without fear of retaliation. This policy establishes a basic process for receiving, reviewing and responding to complaints and reports of suspected wrongdoing.

Organization contact

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1. What can be reported

Concerns may include poor conduct, unfair treatment, discrimination, harassment, safeguarding concerns, misuse of resources, fraud, corruption, conflicts of interest, unsafe project activities, misuse of personal information, or dissatisfaction with an NRI service or decision.

2. Who may raise a concern

Anyone affected by or connected with NRI's work may make a complaint, including community members, participants, parents or guardians, staff, volunteers, suppliers and partner organizations. A person may raise a concern on behalf of someone else where appropriate and safe.

3. How to submit a complaint

Concerns may be raised verbally or in writing to an NRI leader or the designated complaints contact. NRI should make the process accessible to people who have limited literacy, disabilities or limited access to digital communication. The organization must insert and publicize a named contact and safe contact details before adopting this policy.

If the complaint concerns the person who would normally receive it, the complainant should be able to report it to another designated leader or an independent appropriate channel. If someone is in immediate danger, seek emergency assistance or contact the relevant authorities.

4. Acknowledgement and assessment

Where contact details are available and it is safe to respond, acknowledge receipt promptly. Record the date, nature of the concern, preferred safe method of contact and any immediate risks. Assess urgency, safeguarding needs, conflicts of interest and whether referral to a competent authority is necessary.

5. Review and response

An impartial person with no conflict of interest should review the complaint. Gather relevant information fairly, protect evidence, give people involved an appropriate opportunity to respond, and keep a record of findings and actions. Serious safeguarding or criminal allegations should be referred to qualified authorities where appropriate or legally required; NRI should not conduct an investigation that could put people at risk or interfere with official inquiries.

6. Confidentiality and protection from retaliation

Share information only with people who need it to address the concern, subject to legal and safety obligations. NRI prohibits threats, punishment, intimidation or disadvantage because someone raised a concern in good faith or assisted a review. Anonymous complaints may be considered, although they may limit follow-up.

7. Outcomes and appeals

Where safe and appropriate, inform the complainant that the matter has been reviewed and provide an outcome or next steps without disclosing another person's confidential information. If the complainant believes the process was unfair, NRI should provide a review by a different leader or an independent appropriate person where feasible.

8. Records and learning

Keep complaint records securely with restricted access and retain them according to applicable law and NRI's records schedule. Review patterns to improve programmes and prevent recurrence. Do not publish identifying details without a lawful and appropriate basis.

9. Approval and review

Status: NRI must designate safe reporting contacts and an alternate route for complaints about leadership before adoption. Review annually and after serious cases.

NORTHERN RESILIENCE INITIATIVES (NRI)

Human Resources and Volunteer Policy

Fair engagement, clear responsibilities and safe working practices

Purpose

This policy sets a starting framework for engaging staff and volunteers in support of NRI's community development work. It should be applied consistently with Kenyan law, any signed contracts, donor requirements and NRI's approved governance arrangements.

Organization contact

NORTHERN RESILIENCE INITIATIVES (NRI)
Northern Kenya
Email: resiliencenorthern@gmail.com
Telephone: 07 01 780 748

1. Scope and principles

This policy applies to employees, volunteers, interns, consultants and other people engaged by NRI, while recognizing that their legal status and rights may differ. NRI aims to promote fairness, inclusion, respect, transparency and safe working conditions.

2. Recruitment and selection

Recruitment should be based on the role's genuine requirements, relevant skills and suitability. Advertisements and selection decisions should be fair and non-discriminatory. Roles, responsibilities, supervision, time commitments, compensation or volunteer status should be explained clearly before engagement.

3. Engagement terms and records

Employees should receive written employment terms as required by law. Volunteers should receive a clear description of duties, expected time, supervision, expenses or allowances if any, confidentiality obligations and the voluntary nature of the role. Keep personnel records securely and limit access to authorized people.

4. Induction, supervision and development

Provide an induction covering NRI's mission, relevant policies, safeguarding, code of conduct, health and safety, reporting channels and role expectations. Assign a supervisor or contact person and offer reasonable feedback, support and training.

5. Equality, dignity and harassment

NRI does not tolerate discrimination, bullying, sexual harassment, exploitation or retaliation. Concerns should be reported through an appropriate channel and handled fairly, promptly and as confidentially as practicable.

6. Working hours, safety and expenses

Agree work schedules and responsibilities in advance and comply with applicable legal requirements. For field activities, assess risks, share emergency arrangements and report incidents. Reimbursements or allowances must be approved in advance where practicable and supported by records; no one should approve their own claim.

7. Conflicts, confidentiality and organizational property

Disclose actual or potential conflicts of interest. Protect personal, community, donor and organizational information. Use equipment, accounts, funds and other NRI property responsibly and return items when engagement ends.

8. Performance, grievances and ending engagement

Address performance or conduct concerns fairly and consistently with contracts and applicable law. Provide a way to raise grievances without retaliation. Ending employment or volunteer engagement should follow the applicable agreement, fair procedures and legal requirements.

9. Approval and review

Status: NRI must confirm its actual staffing structure, supervisory roles, volunteer arrangements and grievance contacts before adoption. Review annually.

NORTHERN RESILIENCE INITIATIVES (NRI)

Environmental and Community Protection Policy

Do no harm in water security, climate resilience and community development

Purpose

This policy reflects NRI's focus on water security, climate resilience, environmental conservation and sustainable livelihoods in Northern Kenya. It provides basic safeguards for planning and carrying out activities with communities and the environment.

Organization contact

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1. Scope and commitments

This policy applies to NRI leaders, staff, volunteers, contractors and partners involved in project planning, community engagement, procurement, fieldwork and delivery. NRI aims to respect community rights, prevent avoidable harm, use resources responsibly and comply with applicable environmental and other laws.

2. Community participation and respect

Engage affected communities early and in a language and format they can understand. Explain a project's purpose, likely benefits, limitations, risks, selection criteria and complaint channels. Seek meaningful participation and appropriate consent, respect local knowledge and avoid making promises about funding or services that have not been approved.

3. Environmental risk and water projects

Before water storage, rainwater harvesting, tree planting or other field activities, assess foreseeable risks to people, land, water sources, habitats and existing users. Obtain required permissions and technical advice. Use competent providers for engineering, water quality and safety matters; do not represent water as safe to drink without appropriate testing. Avoid causing contamination, erosion, unsafe access or conflict over water.

4. Climate resilience and natural resources

Promote practical, locally appropriate approaches that support resilience and long-term sustainability. Choose suitable species and planting sites for tree-planting projects, consider water availability and maintenance needs, and avoid activities that damage sensitive habitats or undermine local livelihoods.

5. Inclusion and protection of vulnerable groups

Consider how activities affect women, children, older people, people with disabilities, pastoralist communities and households facing vulnerability. Make participation as accessible as practical and take steps to prevent exploitation, discrimination and exclusion from project benefits.

6. Health, safety and incident response

Identify field risks, use appropriate protective equipment and safe working practices, and explain relevant safety information to participants. Stop or adapt an activity if there is a serious unmanaged risk. Report injuries, environmental damage, contamination, community conflict or other significant incidents to NRI leadership promptly and take reasonable steps to reduce further harm.

7. Partners, procurement and accountability

Where feasible, work with competent and responsible suppliers and partners. Explain expected environmental and community safeguards in relevant agreements. Keep records of consultations, permissions, risk assessments, incidents and corrective actions, consistent with applicable law and donor requirements.

8. Complaints, monitoring and review

Community members should be able to raise concerns through NRI's complaints procedure. NRI should monitor whether activities create unintended harm and adjust plans when necessary. Review this policy at least annually and after a significant incident or programme change.

9. Approval and review

Status: NRI must confirm who is responsible for environmental and community risk decisions and insert approval details before adoption.